

Really good presentations can close a deal. They can generate new projects. Also, think about this: a top-grade presentation can *cover up* for average or even sub-standard writing and result in, in general, a better impression of the presenter and his work.

An all-too-common assumption is that to create a presentation with impact is time-consuming. It doesn't have to be that way. Much of it is about practice, and about what we'll tell you in Chapter 2. Remember one key point: if you're a good presenter, *the impact per time spent creating the content is high*.

Now for just one real-life testimonial: here's an excerpt from an interview with Jim Reisteter, vice president of Sales and Marketing at Interlink Electronics—a “global leader in the design and manufacture of interface technologies and products.” The interviewer asked, “Death by PowerPoint—PowerPoint is blamed for everything from space shuttle disasters to disaster meetings. What's your opinion?”

Reisteter's response: “Blaming presentation software for bad meetings and bad decisions only serves to highlight the importance of presentations. Since PowerPoint is used by NASA to evaluate the space shuttle program, this gives credence to (the idea) that PowerPoint is a standard for communication.”

Now here's an excerpt from a whitepaper that aims at refuting most critiques of the PowerPoint way of doing things: “PowerPoint makes people fall asleep,” “PowerPoint makes innocent people have daymares,” and in general, those that hint that it is not effective. So, well, here's our excerpt, from *Uses of PowerPoint in the 314L Classroom*, by Meghan Loisel and Rachel Samantha Galer:

*“PowerPoint is a preferred presentation tool for presenters and audiences, when compared to other multimedia such as slides, video, or handouts. When using these other methods of presentation, the audience cannot be engaged in the lecture because their attention is diverted from the lecture to the handout. Through many experiences with PowerPoint in the*